

PQC archive-migration worksheet

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Use one copy per record class. The worksheet identifies evidence that may need to remain verifiable after its original signer, certificate path, software stack, or approved algorithm set has changed. It is an engineering inventory, not legal advice, a compliance determination, or a trust-service profile.

A. Record and horizon

Field	Record-class answer
1. Record class and accountable owner	What is retained, who owns the decision, and can the record be recreated or reissued without changing its evidentiary meaning?
2. Retention trigger and verification horizon	What starts the retention period, what source sets it, and until what date could an independent party need to verify the record? Distinguish retention from the shorter or longer period during which cryptographic proof is expected.
3. Signer and trust basis	Which key signed the record? How is the signer bound to that key? Which certificate, explicit key pin, registry entry, or other trust decision must a future verifier reproduce?
4. Timestamp and validation evidence	Is there a trusted time assertion? What bytes does it cover? Which certificate path, policy, revocation data, and validation time assumptions would be needed later?
5. Signature algorithm, encoding, and acceptance policy	Record the algorithm and parameters, wire encoding or OID, hybrid composition rule, and the relying party's policy for classical-only transition evidence. Avoid a single value such as "PQC supported."
6. Preserved verification capability	Name the independent verifier, version, runtime, dependencies, schemas, positive vector, negative controls, expected first-failure codes, and the location of an offline replay bundle.
7. Renewal, revalidation, and disposition action	Choose and date the action: bounded classical acceptance; hybrid signing for new records; preservation plus evidence renewal; migration to a new container; or documented expiry and disposal. Name the trigger and owner.

B. Decision sequence

1. **Can the record be recreated later without changing what it proves?** If yes, document the controlled reissue path. If no, treat it as archive evidence.
2. **Does the expected verification horizon outlive any signing algorithm, key, certificate, timestamp path, dependency, or policy assumption?** If yes or unknown, record a migration action rather than a generic support claim.
3. **For new records, is classical-only evidence still permitted?** State the end condition. If PQC is required, make that a relying-party verification policy and test a legitimately generated classical-only package.
4. **Can an independent implementation verify a positive package?** Preserve at least one positive cross-implementation vector before relying on the format.
5. **Do negative controls reach the intended decision points?** Include signature tamper, incomplete hybrid pair, structural stripping, payload change, and any encoding or trust-basis boundary that matters.
6. **Can the evidence be replayed offline on a clean machine?** Preserve the package, hashes, expected outputs, verifier source or binaries, dependency lock files, and a short operator procedure.

C. Recorded outcome

Decision	Entry
Current acceptance policy	classical allowed until: ____ / hybrid if present / PQC required
Next migration or renewal event	Trigger/date: ____ Owner: ____
Preserved replay bundle	Location/version/DOI: ____
Last independent replay	Date: ____ Implementations: ____ Result: ____
Residual limitation accepted by	Name/role: ____ Date: ____

Review rule: revisit the worksheet when the record class, retention source, algorithm policy, trust basis, verifier dependency, or archive process changes.